



Cheat Sheet — Introduction to C Programming

Key Terms

- **C Programming Language:** A general-purpose, procedural programming language developed in the early 1970s.
- **Dennis Ritchie:** The creator of the C programming language at Bell Labs.
- **Procedural Language:** A programming paradigm based on the concept of procedure calls and structured programming.
- **Portability:** The ability of C programs to run on different machines with minimal or no modification.
- **Structure of a C Program:** The basic layout including headers, main function, declarations, and statements.
- **Compilation:** The process of converting C source code into machine code using a compiler.
- **Standard Library:** A collection of pre-written functions in C for common tasks like input/output and string handling.

Formulas & Rules

- C programs start execution from the `main()` function.
- Each statement in C ends with a semicolon `;`.
- Use `#include` to add standard libraries at the beginning of the program.
- Variables must be declared before use.
- C supports structured programming using functions and control statements.
- Comments are written using `/* comment */` for multi-line or `//` for single-line.
- C is case-sensitive; variable and function names must be used consistently.